

Citicorp – Intern Interview Experience

About the company

Citi is a global bank that offers a variety of financial services, including banking, credit cards, and investment solutions. It operates in more than 160 countries and values innovation, diversity, and teamwork, creating an inclusive workplace where employees can grow. Citi's mission is to help people, businesses, and communities achieve their financial goals.

Role: Personal Banking & Wealth Management Technology (PBWMT)

Stipend: 75,000 INR per month

Duration of internship: 8-10 weeks

Selection Process :

The Selection process had 3 rounds.

1. Online test
2. Technical Interview
3. HR Interview

1. Online test

This online test had 4 sections basically.

- 1st section - Numerical and Logical Reasoning
- 2nd section - Quantitative aptitude
- 3rd section - MCQs on Data Structures and Algorithm
- 4th section - Coding round

First section contained questions from permutations and combinations, ratio and proportions, distributions, finding odd one out. One of the questions that I could recollect is the **classic garland problem**. It goes like "Number of ways in which 'm' different flowers can be strung to form a garland so that 'n' flowers are never separated are? ".

Second section had questions like evaluating the expression and problems on profit and loss, discounts, time and work, speed and distance , LCM and HCF.

The third section aims to test the candidate's understanding of programming concepts and DSA. It included questions on trees, sorting, recursive algorithms,

memory management, bit manipulation, binary arithmetic, function overloading, and pointer manipulation.

There were also questions where the output of a code snippet had to be selected. Apart from that we had questions with two code snippets and I was required to choose the correct conclusion based on both.

Fourth section had 2 coding questions. Both the questions were based on string manipulation. They were straightforward and quite easy. This section had a 40-minute time frame, and we were allowed to switch between the questions as needed. Whereas for the first 3 sections, we were given barely 1 minute for each question to solve.

In this test, the first three sections were crucial, as solving the aptitude questions in 1 minute was very challenging and this played a major role in determining our selection for the next round, as almost all candidates were able to solve the questions in the fourth section correctly.

2. Technical Interview (30.09.2024)

A total of 25 students from CEG and MIT have been shortlisted for technical interview. Both HR and Technical interviews were in-person interviews which held at CUIC, CEG.

The interviews were conducted across 5-6 rooms, with students being randomly assigned to each. Some rooms had a single interviewer, while others had two. I was interviewed by a panel of two interviewers.

I entered the room carrying three copies of my resume, as instructed. After greeting the interviewers, I handed them my resume. The interview began with the interviewers introducing themselves, followed by them asking me to introduce myself.

I shared my educational journey, starting from my 10th grade to my current studies in college. I also highlighted my involvement in various clubs and organizations, emphasizing my roles and positions to showcase my leadership and teamwork skills. Be prepared with this self-introduction as it makes the first impression.

After reviewing my resume, they asked me to explain the DBMS project I worked on in my 4th semester. It was an NGO Management project aimed at bringing together various NGOs to help people in need. I explained the project in detail, including the tech stacks used for frontend and backend development, as well as how it benefited the end users. I was also told to describe the structure of the database created.

Since our team was very attached to the project, we named it "PRANAVAM" which reflects our motive of love in helping the needy and designed logo too. I mentioned this, and they appreciated it. They also asked about any unique or special features that set our project apart from others.

They asked me about SDLC and the process of creating a product. At the time of the interview, I was in my 5th semester, and we hadn't yet studied "Software Engineering". However, I was familiar with a few basic concepts related to the topic. I believe it's good to be honest with the interviewer about not knowing all the details and that they may help you. So, I answered these questions based on my basic knowledge of the subject. They also asked me about my favourite subject, to which I replied *DBMS*. They then asked if I could write queries for any type of data retrieval, and I confidently responded with a *yes*.

They asked me how the repetitive task of a person who manually verifies data correctness and inserts it into a table could be improved. I explained that writing traditional programs can only handle a limited set of predefined conditions, which reduces their overall effectiveness for dynamic and complex data validation. Therefore, I suggested using machine learning (ML) to automate data validation, allowing dynamic checks based on learned patterns before inserting the data into tables. Apart from this, they asked me few questions on OOPS.

In the end, they asked me what advice I would give to the juniors of my college. I told them that, apart from encouraging them to develop their technical skills, I would also strongly recommend joining various clubs and associations, as college is the most important platform for developing social and networking skills. I also asked about their journey with the company. Finally, I thanked them and shook hands.

2. HR Interview (30.09.2024)

From the 25 students who were qualified for technical round, 12 were selected for the next round (HR).

It was a one-to-one interview. Since he had a copy of my resume on his laptop, I didn't hand over my resume. He began with his introduction, and then I followed with my own introduction. When I mentioned my involvement in a dance club, he asked about the style of dance we practice and the number of members in the club. I shared details about the events we participated in and the prizes we won.

As I mentioned my participation in track events as an athlete in my resume, he asked about my main sport and my time record for the 100-meter sprint, as I told him I was a sprinter. He also inquired about the places we travelled to for sports meets. He seemed quite impressed by my versatility, being active in different fields.

When he encouraged me to ask questions, I inquired about the work culture at Citi. He highlighted about various sports and cultural activities within the company and shared his involvement in sports.

Later, he asked me a stress-based question: "*What if we don't hire you?*" I replied that while I would feel disappointed for some time, I would learn from the experience, and start preparing for my next interview. I added that this mindset of resilience and adaptability is something my experience in sports has taught me.

Out of 12 people, 6 were selected for PBWM intern role, and by god's grace I was one among them.

All the best!

S SREENITHIKA (2022-2026) CSE (Q)

Feel free to contact me!

Email id: sreenithikas@gmail.com

Linkedin: <http://www.linkedin.com/in/sreenithikasaravanakumar>